

What was that again?

“Network: Any thing reticulated or decussated, at equal distances, with interstices between the intersections.” — Samuel Johnson, Dictionary of the English Language (1755).

Murphy's Laws of Computing

1. When computing, whatever happens, behave as though you meant it to happen.

2. When you get to the point where you really understand your computer, it's probably obsolete.

3. The first place to look for information is in the section of the manual where you least expect to find it.

4. When the going gets tough, upgrade.

5. For every action, there is an equal and opposite malfunction.

6. To err is human... to blame your computer for your mistakes is even more human, it is downright natural.

7. He who laughs last probably made a back-up.

8. If at first you do not succeed, blame your computer.

9. A complex system that does not work is invariably found to have evolved from a simpler system that worked just fine.

10. The number one cause of computer problems is computer solutions.

11. A computer program will always do what you tell it to do, but rarely what you want to do.

“When all else fails,  
read the instructions.”

— L. Iasellio



Your chance to bite back!

Highlight the lighter side of computing. Mail your contributions to Backbyte Digit, Plot D-222/2, TTC Industrial Area, MIDC, Shirvane, Nerul, Navi Mumbai 400 706 or e-mail us at [backbyte@jasubhai.com](mailto:backbyte@jasubhai.com)

There are three kinds of death in this world. There's heart death, there's brain death, and there's being off the network

— Guy Almes  
(Chief Engineer, Internet2)

ABIT promises Instant Performance...



...Definitely something to be taken with a pinch of salt

Emoticons you may never use!

:~D\*

Person laughing so hard that he/she does not notice a 5-legged spider hanging from his/her lip

>8-O-(&)

Person just realising that he/she has a tapeworm

.-)

Person who can smile despite losing an eyeball

:V:-|

Person who cannot figure out why nobody wants to talk to him/her, little suspecting that there is an alligator on his/her head

~oE]:-|

Fisherpersion heading for market with a basket containing a three-legged octopus that is giving off smell rays

>:-| -{9

Person who is none too pleased to be giving birth to a squirrel

Selected from [www.randomhouse.com/features/davebarry/emoticon.html](http://www.randomhouse.com/features/davebarry/emoticon.html)

Software Development Cycle

■ Programmer produces code he believes is bug-free.

■ Product is tested. 20 bugs are found.

■ Programmer fixes 10 of the bugs and explains to the testing department that the other 10 aren't really bugs.

■ Testing department finds that five of the fixes didn't work and discovers 15 new bugs.

■ Repeat steps 3 and 4 three times.

■ Due to marketing pressure and an extremely premature product announcement based on an overly optimistic programming schedule, the product is released.

■ Users find 137 new bugs.

■ Original programmer, having cashed his royalty cheque, is nowhere to be found.

■ Newly-assembled programming team fixes almost all of the 137 bugs, but introduce 456 new ones.

■ Original programmer sends underpaid testing department a postcard from Fiji. Entire testing department quits.

■ Company is bought in a hostile takeover by competitor using profits from their latest release, which had 783 bugs.

■ New CEO is brought in by board of directors. He hires a programmer to redo program from scratch.

■ Programmer produces code he believes is bug-free...

■ Life goes on...

Contributed by Sameer Goswami